

CREATING A NEW TASK USING IFTTT



1. Click on 'Create a task'.
2. On the next page, click on the big blue 'this' and choose a channel to trigger your task. For the purpose of our example, choose the Facebook icon and log in. Your Facebook channel is now active.
3. For the trigger, select the option that says "You are tagged in a photo". This action will automatically be triggered every time you're tagged in a picture. Ifttt usually polls your data every 15 minutes, so there might be a slight delay in the action.
4. The next step is to choose the action you want it to perform. Click on the big blue

'that' on your screen.

5. Our action is to save the picture in to Dropbox, so we select the Dropbox channel and activate it using your Dropbox credentials. Select the 'Add file from URL' action.
6. Complete the task by specifying the necessary details. For this task, select Image Source to be the file URL, and designate the path to save the photo in Dropbox.
7. Add tags to easily find your task and save it.



your currently active tasks and channels. If you're not quite sure what ifttt does, we'll walk you through it with an example. Let's say that every time someone tags a photo of you on Facebook, you want to save that photo to your computer and be able to access it even without a Facebook login. A good idea would be to save that picture to your Dropbox, so you not only have a local copy but also have access it from anywhere. Here's how to create a task that automatically saves your tagged photos from Facebook to Dropbox: You can also ON/OFF the tasks you created on ifttt. If you think your task can be helpful to others, make it a 'recipe' to let others use it too. There already exist a huge number of these recipes, so spend a few minutes looking through the list, and you might find what you need. Some popular ifttt recipes include:

1. Cross post between social networks - Post all your tweets to Facebook or vice-versa
2. Automatically save the links in your favourite tweets to Readability/Pocket/Instapaper.
3. If Facebook profile picture changes, update twitter profile picture

4. When a new book is added to Kindle Top 100 free ebooks, notify me via email.
5. Make it such that if it is going to rain, I get a text message.
6. Save all Instagram photos to Dropbox.
7. When you publish a new blog post on Wordpress/Tumblr/Blogger/Posterous, send a tweet or update your Facebook status with the link and the title of the post to notify your friends.
8. Send your favourite Google Reader articles to Buffer, and let it take care of spacing out your tweets.
9. Save your bookmarks to multiple bookmarking services like Delicious, Pinboard, Diigo or Evernote.
10. Watch Twitter for #Appoftheweek and send an email notification for the same.

While ifttt is great when it comes to automating tasks involving your online accounts, it can't do much else. Wappwolf (<http://wappwolf.com/dropboxautomator/>) is an excellent online tool that can automate several file-conversion tasks for you. It monitors a folder in your Dropbox, Google Drive or Box account for files of a certain type, and whenever you add such a file, it can perform a set of actions on those files, most prominent among which is file conversion. You can convert most popular audio, video and document formats and can have Wappwolf perform additional actions such as uploading it to Google Docs, adding it to Evernote or uploading it to your Amazon Kindle device.

Other web automation services include <https://zapier.com/>. It's similar to ifttt but has fewer networks, with the absence of many popular ones like Facebook. On the upside, it provides an intuitive drag 'n drop interface. Ping.fm (<http://ping.fm/>) can manage your social networks for you, by posting to all your social media sites from one place. You really need such a service in this day and age when society places great emphasis on your online persona. Tarpipes (<http://tarpipes.com/>), similar to Yahoo-pipes is a more flexible approach when it comes to publishing data on the web. The service makes it easy to share content across different social media applications. The workflow tab lets you decide what part of your data will be published where. For example, you can set up a Tarpipes to receive an email and post the title to twitter, upload an attachment to Dropbox or Flickr and archive the text of the email by saving it to Evernote. Mac users can also make use of Dropipes, an OSX application that uses Tarpipes's API, to upload pictures directly to the service from your desktop. Tarpipes is your solution when you want to customize the flow of your data more granularly. Having multiple online accounts means you get access

to a rich variety of digital content, but managing it all can be tedious. These tools can greatly decrease your maintenance tasks by truly putting the web to work for you! 

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REASON

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